Louisa County Water Authority
Board of Directors
December 11, 2024

MEMBERS PRESENT: Mr. Bob Hardy, Chairman (for this meeting); Mr. Robert Morgan; Mr. David Kies; Mr. Byron Wilson; Mr. Tom Filer (*arrived at 6:02 pm)*

MEMBERS ABSENT: Mr. Judson Foster, Chairman and Mr. Douglas Smith, Vice-Chairman

OTHERS PRESENT: Ms. Pam Baughman, General Manager; Ms. Danielle Mychajlonka, Human Resources Manager; Mr. Chris Compton, Maintenance Manager; Mr. Manning Woodward, Louisa County Board of Supervisors; Mr. Mitchell Sasser, The Central Virginian; Ms. Patricia Smith, County Attorney

A. Call to Order

Secretary Baughman called the meeting to order at 6:00 pm.

The Secretary informed the Board members present that the Chairman and Vice-Chairman were unable to attend the meeting. To proceed, a chairman would need to be elected to preside over the meeting.

Mr. Kies made a motion to elect Mr. Hardy the Chairman for the December 11, 2024 - Louisa County Water Authority Board of Directors meeting. The motion was seconded by Mr. Morgan and carried 4-0 among the members present.

1. ADOPTION OF THE AGENDA

Chairman Hardy asked if there were changes or additions to the agenda. The General Manager asked to make two changes 1) move the meeting date from January 8, 2025 to January 15, 2025, as requested by Chairman Foster; and 2) add item 6. C. Nanofiltration pump replacement. Mr. Kies made a motion to adopt the agenda as amended. The motion was seconded by Mr. Morgan and carried 4-0 among the members present.

B. Presentations

C. Citizen Information

D. Consent Agenda

2. APPROVAL OF THE MINUTES:

A. NOVEMBER 13, 2024 – REGULAR BUSINESS MEETING

3. TREASURER'S REPORT:

A. O & M REPORT / CAPITAL REVENUE & EXPENDITURE REPORT – NOVEMBER 2024
B. APPROVAL OF DISBURSEMENTS – NOVEMBER 2024
C. CONSTRUCTION FUND – NOVEMBER 2024

The Board reviewed the Consent Agenda and Treasurer's Report. Upon completion of the review, Mr. Kies made a motion to approve the Consent Agenda and Treasurer's Report. The motion was seconded by Mr. Wilson and carried 4-0 among the members present.

Mr. Tom Filer arrived at 6:02 pm.

E. Old Business

4. NEW BRIDGE WWTP

A. SANITARY SEWER OVERFLOW

The Board was informed that staff believe the cause of the Sanitary Sewer Overflow was when the building housing the restaurants jetted and cleaned their sewer line on October 30, 2024. All the grease that was cleaned out of the building sewer lines was washed into the first pump station. All the grease ended up being pumped into the collection systems and gathered in the line from last manhole into the influent line into

lagoon #1. The collection system is being monitored closely and the entire gravity line is being scheduled for a thorough cleanout by a commercial jetter in the coming days to ensure the line is clean and opened to prevent additional sanitary sewer overflows.

The General Manager discussed with the Board the enforcement of the Grease Trap Policy to its fullest extent and the preventative maintenance of jetting the collection system gravity lines to prevent further sanitary sewer overflow.

5. RIGHT-OF-WAY CLEARING

The Board was informed that Sam Massie, Louisa County Procurement and the General Manager met with S & K Enterprises, LLC, a firm from West Virginia on November 22, 2024 to discuss the price proposal for right-of-way clearing. S & K stated that the price was the going rate and they would not negotiate the cost. They stated that their crew would be able to clear approximately a half of a mile/day, which equated to 2.42 acres per mile. Once reclaimed, the maintenance would need to take place annually. When their crew was dispatched, they would stay in the area until the job was completed. They also stated that right-of-way clearing could not be done if trees were above 4" in diameter during the long-eared bat nesting season.

S & K stated that they are anxious to get the work and would expect our staff to mark any infrastructure in the right-of-way.

The truck and trailer have been ordered. Staff have not been able to schedule borrowing the County's equipment due to the issues that have arisen since the November meeting and the Thanksgiving holiday.

After some discussion, Mr. Wilson made a motion to authorize staff to lease for six months, from James River Equipment, a skid steer with needed equipment and to proceed with training staff. The motion was seconded by Mr. Morgan. Further discussion ensued and Mr. Wilson withdrew his motion.

After further discussion, Mr. Kies made a motion to authorize the General Manager to contract with S & K Enterprises LLC to clear 20 miles of right-of-way. The motion was seconded by Mr. Filer and carried 5-0 among the members present.

6. NORTHEAST CREEK WATER TREATMENT PLANT

A. SLUDGE VAC CONSTRUCTION SCHEDULE

The construction schedule for the Sludge Vac System at the Northeast Creek Water Treatment Plant was included in the agenda. The contractor is still waiting on equipment and hopeful that the equipment will arrive on time to complete the project on the schedule provided.

B. BOIL WATER ADVISORY

The Board reviewed the documents from the November 19, 2024 boil water advisory and lifting of the advisory on November 21, 2024. The loss of pressure in the Northeast Creek distribution system was caused when the tanks were isolated from the system to replace the altitude valve, the plant was offline for additional valve work and the bypass valve between the Town of Louisa and the distribution system was not opened. Once the issue was discovered, the contractor stated that they needed to install the final gasket and tighten the bolts, and it would be complete. The valves could then be opened for water to flow. Instead of making a bad situation worse, the General Manager made the decision to wait for the contractor to complete the work and open the valve instead of opening the bypass valve. This prevented the Town of Louisa from being impacted, they did not lose water pressure, and the boil water advisory did not apply to them. The work was completed in less than ten minutes from the discovery of the bypass valve not being opened and to the valves being re-opened. Everything returned to normal quickly.

The Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water initially stated that no boil water advisory needed to be issued, later changing their mind. This caused confusion and a delay in informing our customers.

C. NANOFILTRATION PUMP REPLACEMENT

During routine CIPs the week of December 02, 2024, a pump on the Nanofiltration System failed. The cost to repair the pump is $11,000. The cost to replace the pump is $14,755. The General Manager authorized the replacement. It will take approximately 8 weeks to receive the pump. While the pump is not working, the Nanofiltration System is being bypassed. This could cause a rise in Disinfection By-products during the first quarter of 2025 while the Nanofiltration System is offline. The Virginia Department of Health – Office of Drinking Water has been notified. They believe our Disinfection By-products are so low that bypassing the Nanofiltration System will not cause a violation. Disinfection By-products are examined by a rolling average.

The General Manger was asked to confirm that one skid could be run and still bypass, minimizing the TOC and potential for disinfection byproducts formation in the distribution system.

7. UPDATED QUOTE FOR WATER INSTALLATION AT THE LAGOON PUMP STATION

The Board reviewed the updated quote for water installation at the Lagoon pump station. No action was taken.

F. New Business

8. REGIONAL WATER SUPPLY PLANNING

The General Manager informed the Board that the Regional Water Supply Planning would be beginning after the first of the year. The localities of Green County, Albemarle County, City of Charlottesville, Louisa County, Fluvanna County and Buckingham County will be included in our region.

9. ZION CROSSROADS WATER LEAK

On Wednesday, November 27, 2024 the maintenance staff found a significant leak on the Crossing Point property, located behind the McDonalds and UVA Dialysis Center. Chris was able to close a valve until the repair was able to be made on December 2, 2024. Staff believes this leak had been happening for quite some time and the cause of the water losses we have been experiencing.

G. Reports

H. General Manager's Report

● James River Water Project – December 2024 update –

1) The first of three fields has been cleared for excavation.
2) The wet well excavation and construction will begin in the first quarter of 2025.
3) Cultural Resources work is on track.
4) Much of the raw water line has been installed.

● **November levels**: At the end of November 2024, the static well levels are up just under 70 feet from the end of October 2024 levels. From November 2023 to November 2024, the well levels are down just under 80 feet.

The US Drought Map indicates moderate drought conditions for all of Louisa County, with severe drought across neighboring counties to the north and east.

● The General Manager met with the Town of Louisa Water & Sewer Committee to discuss several topics including new developments in the Town of Louisa and the pending Louisa Regional WWTP Ammonia Nitrogen upgrade forthcoming after the permit renewal in 2027.

● The Louisa Regional WWTP re-sampled for toxicity and passed the second round.

● On December 12, 2024, the Emergency Response Plan Table-Top Exercise will be performed. Representatives from DCR, VDEM, County Administration, Fire/EMS, engineers, Sherrif's Department, VDOT and others will be in attendance.

● The current past due listing is down to $7,307.13 from the past due listing provided in the General Manager's Report, which reported the past due balance of $9,038.20.

● The New Bridge WWTP upgrade – the contract for the design and contract administration work has been signed. Once the plans reach the 30% completed phase, the County of Louisa will need to decide if they would like to order materials to shorten the construction time. There is some risk to the County if that step is taken.

● The only items to be completed for Spring Creek Wells #1 & #2 are a final inspection with the engineers, an inspection with VDH, and the final piece of tying in the communications.

● On December 17, 2024, Delegate Amy Laufer will be touring the Louisa Regional WWTP and Northeast Creek Water Treatment Plant.

● On December 10, 2024, Louisa County Water Authority staff celebrated Nancy Pugh's Retirement.

● Authority staff will gather for a Christmas luncheon on Thursday, December 19, 2024.

● Town of Louisa meter vaults – Rt.22 Davis Highway – both insertion valves are complete. Work will commence after the first of the year. Should be completed by January 31, 2025.

I. Committees

J. Short Notice Items

K. Closed Session

Closed Sessions for Consultation with Legal Counsel: Va. Code Section 2.2-3711(A)(7): Meetings for consultation with legal counsel and briefings by staff members or consultants pertaining to actual or probable litigation, where such consultation or briefing in an open meeting would adversely affect the negotiating or litigating posture of the public body.

Closed Sessions for Unannounced Projects: Va. Code Section 2.2-3711(A)(5): This section permits closed meetings for discussion concerning prospective or expanding business or industry when no previous announcement has been made.

Closed Session for Discussion and Consideration of Personnel Matters: Va. Code Section 2.2-3711(A)(1): For the discussion and consideration of personnel matters including the discipline, appointment, assignment, performance and salaries of specific appointees and employees.

RETURN TO OPEN MEETING:

Chairman Hardy closed the closed session and immediately reconvened in regular open meeting at 8:09 pm.

CERTIFY:

Chairman Hardy read the following statement prior to the vote to certify the closed session.

"I will now poll members to certify that, to the best of your knowledge, only public business matters lawfully exempted from the open meeting requirements under the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, and as identified in the motion for which the closed meeting was convened, were discussed, and considered by the Board. If any member believes that the Board varied from the purpose stated for the closed meeting, please state so and the reason prior to casting the vote." A roll call vote was requested with the following results:

Mr. Foster	ABSENT
Mr. Smith	ABSENT
Mr. Filer	YES
Mr. Hardy	YES
Mr. Kies	YES
Mr. Morgan	YES
Mr. Wilson	YES

The motion carried 5-0 among the members present.

Next meeting date - The next business meeting is scheduled for January 15, 2025. (Please note the change in date.)

The Board discussed the process taken for addressing the right-of-way clearing and directed the General Manager to request needed equipment in future budget requests.

L. Adjournment

THERE BEING NO FURTHER BUSINESS, Mr. Filer made a motion to adjourn at 8:22 pm. The motion was seconded by Mr. Wilson and carried 5-0 among the members present.

BY ORDER OF:

Mr. Bob Hardy
Chairman
LOUISA COUNTY WATER AUTHORITY